

TRAVEL DIARY - SRI LANKA & MALDIVES (SAMPLE)

GENERAL TRIP INFORMATION & LOGISTICS

Destination: Sri Lanka Cultural Triangle & Highlands + Maldives South Male Atoll.

Visas: Sri Lanka ETA online before arrival. Maldives IMUGA declaration within 96h.

Currency: LKR in Sri Lanka. Clean post-2013 USD bills accepted across Maldives islands.

Etiquette: Shoulders and knees covered in all temples. Footwear removed at entrance.

Emergency Contacts: Local Partner (+94 7X XXX XXXX) / Maldives Dispatch (+960 XXXXXXXX).

DAY-BY-DAY OFFICIAL ITINERARY (PART 1)

Day 1: Arrival in Negombo

- International flight arrival at Bandaranaike International Airport (CMB).
- Group transfer to Negombo hotel. Welcome orientation meeting in the lobby.
- Group coastal welcome dinner. Overnight in Negombo.

Day 2: Cultural Triangle - Anuradhapura

- Morning transfer from Negombo to ancient Anuradhapura (approx 5 hours).
- Guided tour of UNESCO sacred ruins, stupas, and Bodhi Tree sanctuary.
- Sunset visit to Mihintale complex. Overnight in Anuradhapura.

Day 3: Minneriya Safari & Sigiriya Lion Rock

- 4x4 Jeep Safari in Minneriya / Hurulu Eco Park for wild elephant gathering.
- Traditional agrarian village lunch experience included.
- Afternoon climb of ancient Sigiriya Lion Rock Fortress. Overnight in Sigiriya.

Day 4: Dambulla Cave Temples to Kandy

- Sunrise hike up Pidurangala Rock with direct views of Sigiriya Fortress.
- Dambulla Cave Temples complex visit and Matale spice valley educational stop.
- Evening puja ceremony at Temple of the Sacred Tooth Relic. Overnight in Kandy.

Day 5: Central Highlands & Scenic Train to Ella

- Nuwara Eliya tea hills journey and Ceylon tea factory guided visit.
- Scenic blue train ride from Nanu Oya to Ella through mountain tea estates.
- Arrival and relaxed dinner in Ella village. Overnight in Ella.

Day 6: Ella Peaks & Nine Arches Bridge

- Morning hike to Little Adam's Peak viewpoint.
- Midday stop at Nine Arches Bridge for scheduled train passage.
- Optional afternoon adventure (Flying Ravana zipline). Overnight in Ella.

DAY-BY-DAY OFFICIAL ITINERARY (PART 2)

Day 7: White Water Rafting & Road to Colombo

- Descent to Kitulgala for Kelani River white water rafting expedition.
- Transfer to Colombo city. Orientation walk and final Sri Lanka group dinner.
- Overnight in Colombo.

Day 8: Flight to Maldives & Speedboat to Maafushi

- Colombo Airport transfer and flight to Male (Velana International Airport).
- Scheduled speedboat transfer across the atoll to Maafushi local island.
- Island guesthouse check-in and briefing on island customs. Overnight in Maafushi.

Day 9: Bikini Beach & Nurse Shark Snorkeling

- Morning leisure at designated Bikini Beach.
- Optional excursion: Guided boat snorkeling with Nurse Sharks and Stingrays.
- Afternoon scuba diving session or beach relaxation. Overnight in Maafushi.

Day 10: Whale Shark Safari / Gulhi Island

- Optional full-day excursion to South Ari Atoll for Whale Shark and Manta search.
- Alternative: Boat day trip to neighboring local island Gulhi.
- Overnight in Maafushi.

Day 11: Resort Day Pass & Farewell Beach Gathering

- Optional day pass to luxury private resort island (all-inclusive amenities).
- Farewell beach dinner with traditional Maldivian Boduberu music performance.
- Overnight in Maafushi.

Day 12: Departure to Male International Airport

- Hotel check-out and scheduled morning speedboat transfer to Male Airport (MLE).
- Connecting international departure flights. Official services conclude.